2026 BYLAWS

DISCLAIMER:
ALL BYLAWS ARE SUBJECT TO CHANGE IF IT IS IN THE BEST INTEREST OF THE LEAGUE.

The following rules and regulations are current as of: **7 May 2025**

LOG FOR CHANGES TO LEAGUE BYLAWS

Date	Summary of Changes (Most recent changes will be in RED)
2/27/24	Added Table of Contents
3/16/26	Trade deadline moved to 'post' Week 11

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CODE OF CONDUCT

- **Throwing Games/Tanking –** Losing games on purpose by failing to submit a normal lineup will not be tolerated.
- **Submit Weekly Lineups –** It is the owner's responsibility to submit weekly lineups. Failure to do so will not be tolerated.
- **Renting/Holding Players –** Trading a player to a team with the original intention that this player will be returned back to this team at a later date will not be tolerated.
- **Collusion –** Conspiring with other owners will not be tolerated. Examples of this would be renting players, using cash/etc to buy players, dumping players, or owning multiple teams in a league.
- **Participation –** Owners who continue to fail in terms of participation in league activities will be considered abandoned and new owners will be sought after.

KEY DEFINITIONS

TCL - The Contract League
Contract – The amount of time, in years, that the GM has agreed to pay a salary to a player.
Contract Year / League Year – April 1st through March 31st.
Franchise Tag (FT) Player – A restricted free agent specifically tagged by a team and guaranteed a specific salary. ***Each team may use one per year.** [Please see Article 3, Section 9. Franchise Tag (FT) for more information.]
Player – Defined by anyone that is on a roster (Coach and OFF are considered players).
Free Agent (FA) – Any player who is not, or is no longer, under contract with an TCL team.
Injury Designation – The following abbreviations are the official NFL injury codes, which are also used by MFL.com. Their descriptions are as follows:

I = Injured Reserve. A player with this designation cannot play for his current team for the remainder of the season; unless his IR designation is due to being placed on the PUP or IR Designated-to-Return list.

- O = Out* (0% chance the player will play in the upcoming week's game).
- D = Doubtful* (25% chance the player will play in the upcoming week's game).
- Q = Questionable* (60-80% chance the player will play in the upcoming week's game).
- S = Suspended*.

*Note – * = This designation is not allowed for use for an IR position.*
Injured Reserve (IR) – Players declared to be on injured reserve by the official NFL injury report and MyFantasyLeague.com (MFL) injury designations can fill these positions. Each team has 50 available IR positions, max allowed as per MFL capabilities. [Please see Article 2, Section 6: Injured Reserve (IR) for more information.]
Taxi Squad (TS) – Non-active roster slots for developmental players who are in their first 3-years in the NFL. Only rookies, 2nd and 3rd year players may be placed on the Taxi Squad that has a contract value less than or equal to the value of the 1.01 draft player or pick position. The advantage of using the Taxi Squad is that only 10 percent of the TS player's salary counts against the team's salary cap. However, you risk another team claiming the player. [Please see Article 2, Section 5. Taxi Squad for more information.]
Rookie Contract (RC) – A rookie contract is given to any player who is drafted in an TCL rookie draft. The rookie contract length by default is 4 years, with 1st round picks having a 5th-year option.
Salary – The amount an owner has agreed to pay a player annually.

Salary Cap – The maximum amount an owner may spend on his players' salaries. *Note – the salary cap will change based on the NFL's changes.* [Please see Article 3, Section 1: Salary Cap for more information.]
Stat Corrections – Stat corrections for all weeks of the season are applied on Thursdays at 10:00am ET.
Transition Tag (TT) Players – An Unrestricted Free Agent specifically tagged by the original team and guaranteed a specific salary. ***Each team may use one per year.** [Please see Article 3, Section 10: Transition Tags (TT) for more information.]
Unrestricted Free Agent (UFA) – A free agent who is not restricted in any way. Any team may bid on and sign any UFA. [Please see Unrestricted Free Agent for more information.]
Undrafted Free Agent (UDFA) – A rookie who went undrafted in the TCL rookie draft.
Waiver Extension Tag – A restricted tag by the original team to keep a waiver pick-up from the previous season. These players were either signed through blind bids or first-come, first-serve (FCFS) waivers. The waiver extension can only be used on **2 players per season**. [Please see Article 3, Section 11: Waiver Extension Tag for more information.]
Blind Bidding - The process of bidding on a player on MFL to acquire them, bidding an appropriate price to out bid the competition.
FCFS - First Come First Serve, the process of picking up a free agent player on MFL during the available period.
Modifier Key – MFL allows admins to enter brief notes for each player via the Rosters page. The following key will be used to track various situations where different rules may apply to a player.

Abbrv.	Modifier / Note	Abbrv.	Modifier / Note
(RC)	Standard Rookie Contract	**(5YO)**	Applied 5th Year Option
(RC1)	Rookie eligible for 5th year option	**(RFA)**	Restricted Free Agent (Players on RC show up on contract summary as RFA)
(FT#)	Franchise Tag - # indicates the number of times a player has been franchise tagged (3 max)	**(HO)**	Holdout - Can't holdout two years in a row
(TT#)	Transition Tag - # (can't TT twice in a row)	**(WT)**	Waiver Tag
(T-1st) **(T-2nd)** **(T-3rd)**	Tender - Round (indicates that the player will be included in the upcoming RFA tender auction)	**(UFA)**	Unrestricted Free Agent (Players headed to FA barring a tag - shows up on contract summary as UFA)

ARTICLE 1 – LEAGUE FEES & PRIZE MONEY

Section 1.1: League Fees

2025 League Fee Key Date(s):

- February 1st - 6pm EST: League Fees are due
- TBD - Deadline to pay for ability to trade future draft picks(after NFL trade deadline).

1. The league fee is **$200** for the 2025 season. (*This is subject to change annually by way of league vote*)

2. The head commissioner's fee is waived each season for running the operations of TCL.
3. The TCL will use Leaguesafe to receive and distribute **all** league funds. This will provide transparency for each league member. *(Leaguesafe does not have a great option for our INT'L members, so we may need to find a workaround)*
4. The Commissioners, at their discretion, may offer orphaned teams at a discounted price in order to keep the league full.
5. After the season ends, the league fee for the upcoming season is due by **6pm EST on February 1st**.
6. An owner failing to meet the payment deadline results in the franchise being declared an orphan and a new owner being sought after, ***unless*** specifically addressed ahead of the deadline with the Commissioner.
7. In order to trade future draft picks, the GM is required to pay their full league fee for the season involving the draft picks. *For example, to trade any 2018 draft picks, the GM must pay $300 of the league fees for that season*. If a GM trades away future draft picks, $300 of the future league fee (for the year involved) is **non-refundable** in the event the GM decides to leave the league. This money will be set aside as a discount for the replacement GM that takes over the abandoned franchise. If a departing GM paid $300 for a future season's draft picks, the $300 will be used as a discount for each season the fee was paid for. *For example, the GM paid $300 for the right to trade away their draft picks for 2021 & 2022. The replacement owner would receive a $300 discount in 2021 and a $300 discount in 2022.* No fees will be accepted after the deadline, and you will be unable to gain access to trade your future draft picks. This date may change season to season, depending on LeagueSafe's capabilities.

Section 1.2: League Payouts

1. The total cash prize pool for 2025 equals **$6200.00** ($200.00 x 31 teams) and is paid out at the end of season (within 5-days after completion of the TCL Super Bowl).
2. 100% of league dues, minus expenses, are paid out to TCL participants. If the league, for whatever reason, is not at capacity for the start of the season, the TCL will determine payouts based on the percentages below.

League Costs	Expense	Total	Percentage of Expense to Total League Fees ($9,300)
MyFantasyLeague.com	$160	$160	1.72%
	Total	**$160**	**1.72%**

3. The TCL features **two opportunities** to win cash prize payouts: Regular-Season & Postseason Achievements.
4. LeagueSafe does charge a small fee when you withdraw money from your account for certain options. The available withdrawal options are:
   1) A gift card (no charge)
   2) A virtual VISA card ($3.00 for mailed card - free for digital card)
   3) Printable e-check ($3.00) (May not work for GMs outside the US)
   4) A mailed check ($4.00)
   5) Electronic Bank Transfer ($5.00)

Regular-Season Achievements			
Payout Categories	**Payout**	**Total**	**Percentage of Expense to Total League Fees ($9,300)**
Weekly highest total points (per week - x13)	$100	$1300	13.98%
Highest total points (season - x1) NFL Weeks 1-13	$200	$200	2.15%
	Total	**$1500**	**16.13%**

Player Seasonal Achievements			
Payout Categories	**Payout**	**Total**	**Percentage of Expense to Total League Fees ($9,300)**
Offensive MVP - Points (x2)	$100	$200	2.15%
Defensive MVP - Points (x2)	$100	$200	2.15%
	Total	**$400**	**4.30%**

Post-Season Achievements			
Payout Categories	**Payout**	**Total**	**Percentage of Expense to Total League Fees ($9,300)**
Wild Card Teams (x6)	$100	$600	6.45%
Division Champions (x8)	$150	$1200	12.90%
#1 AFC & NFC Seeds (x2)	$200	$400	4.30%
Playoff Wins (x12 - Excludes Super Bowl)	$100	$1,200	12.90%
Super Bowl Loser (x1)	$1,040	$1,040	11.18%
Super Bowl Winner (x1)	$2,800	$2,800	30.12%
	Total	**$7,240**	**77.85%**

Section 1.3: Refund Policy

1. A GM leaving the league will receive a full refund for future pre-payments unless the GM trades away any future draft picks. $300.00 of the future league fee (for the draft picks involved) is **non-refundable** in the event the GM decides to leave the league. This money will be set aside as a discount for the replacement GM that takes over the orphaned franchise. Full refunds for the current season will be immediately granted if the departing GM gives notice prior to the start of the TCL rookie draft. If the GM leaves after the rookie draft has begun, his funds will be temporarily held until the league receives payment from the replacement GM. Once received, the league payment will be refunded to the departing GM. If the franchise remains vacant leading up to the playoffs, no refund will be issued.
2. In the event the TCL ceases to exist, all deposited league funds will be returned to each GM accordingly.

ARTICLE 2 – LEAGUE STRUCTURE

Section 2.1: Front Office Management

1. **League Commissioner: Andrew Goett** (Tampa Bay) is responsible for handling the overall operations of THE Contract League.

2. **Co - Commissioners: Chip Robison** (Detroit) is responsible for handling the day-to-day operations of the AFC Conference and **Jeff Kwit** (Las Vegas) is responsible for handling the day-to-day operations of the NFC Conference. Their duties include:

   - Administer the league settings on MFL.com
   - Administer LeagueSafe
   - Rule on league disputes that may arise, using the League Bylaws as a guide
   - Monitor and respond to general league questions
   - Provide financial calculation of holdouts, franchise/transition tags, contract extensions, and rookie salaries

- Provide guidance to owners using Slack chat, message board, email and/or other forms of communication.

2. **Media Team: (TCL)**

    - Identify new platforms to host league media
    - Develop league media website
    - Assist GMs in posting media
    - Host radio shows
    - Write articles
    - Engage league owners

3. **New Owner Liaison: *Commissioner Team*** is responsible for assisting the commissioners with the new owner search, and google form. League promotion and event organization.

Section 2.2: Teams, Conference, & Divisions

1. The League consists of 32 teams divided into 2 conferences: The American Football Conference (AFC) and The National Football Conference (NFC). Each conference will have 16 teams, broken down into four divisions of teams of four.
2. The league has its own unique player pool, two copies of each player.
3. Players/draft picks may not be traded between conferences.

Section 2.3: Rosters

NOTE - For information on roster violations, please see Article 7, Section 1: Roster Violations and Penalties.

Roster Key Dates:

- Following the trade deadline: TS claims are locked.
- Following week 13: Non-playoff teams' rosters are locked.
- January 1st: Once GMs pay for the upcoming season, they are allowed to begin cleaning up their rosters (cutting expired contacts etc).

1. **A minimum of 48 players and a maximum of 55 players** are **required** for a complete active roster during the regular season.
2. During the off-season, there is no minimum and the maximum roster size is increased to 90 to provide more opportunities to acquire talent. There will be one cutdown date:

    - **Cutdown Day –** Roster max size decreases from 90 to 55 players (or less - not including TS or IR)

Note: Dates for roster cuts may change each season to coincide with the NFL's preseason games.

3. If team(s) fail to complete their cuts at the scheduled date, the Commissioner will remove players from the team(s). Starting with the most recent players added to the roster.
4. There are restrictions regarding the minimum & maximum number of players by position. These restrictions must only be maintained for the duration of the regular season (Sept-Dec). The restrictions include:

    - Number of Coaches on Roster: Minimum of 1, Maximum of 2
    - Number of QBs on Roster: Minimum of 1, Maximum of 4 (doesn't include taxi-squad)

- Number of PKs on Roster: Minimum of 1, Maximum of 2 (doesn't include taxi-squad)
- Number of PNs on Roster: Minimum of 1, Maximum of 2 (doesn't include taxi-squad)
- Number of Team OFF on Roster: Minimum of 1, Maximum of 2

Section 2.4: Starting Lineup

1. Lineups must be submitted prior to kickoff. Players become locked at each individual kickoff.
2. Lineups will be visible for all managers to see, not finalized until kickoff for each player.
3. **Offensive** Lineups must include at least 1 Starting Quarterback and 10 other players, in any variation of the following:

    - 1-2x QB
    - 2-4x RB
    - 2-5x WR
    - 1-4x TE

4. The league uses NFL defensive formations to determine fantasy lineup requirements. [Note - defensive formations are not a capability of MFL like offensive formations are. So, the defensive formations cannot be restricted in the same manner.] Defensive lineup consists of the following four formations: [image below]
5. Because **defensive** formations cannot be restricted by formation, the following MFL capabilities were used to restrict teams from submitting illegal lineups:

The starting Defense includes:

- 1x DT
- 2x DE
- 2x LB
- 2x CB
- 2x S
- 2x Flex Position

The following can be used in the flex position:

- 1x DT
- 1x DE
- 2x LB
- 1x CB
- 1x S

6. **Special Teams** lineups consists of the following positions:

    - Place Kicker (PK): 1
    - Punter (PN): 1

7. **Team Offense (O-Line)** represents an offensive line unit.
8. **Coach** represents the coach of an NFL team.

Section 2.5: Taxi Squad

1. The Taxi Squad is available to teams each season and remains available all season long.

2. Teams may designate up to **16 players** from their team to the TS for development purposes during the regular season (Sept-Dec). During the off-season, teams can have up to **16 players** on the TS. These players are in addition to the 55 active roster players. (*Note – The TCL will follow the NFL, so if the NFL increases/decreases the amount available on the TS, the TCL will do the same.)*
3. **Only rookies, 2nd and 3rd year players** are allowed on the TS. The following positions are not allowed on the TS: Coaches, or Team Offense.
4. Players that qualify above also can't have a contract over the value of the 1.01 drafted player or selection position. The amount may change from year to year, it's based on the highest 1.01 drafted player or selection position. [Example - in the 2023 season the 1.01 draft position has a value of $7.32m. No player with a contract value higher than $7.32m can be placed on the Taxi Squad and subsequently is **ineligible to be dropped from a GMs roster as a free Taxi Squad cut.**]
5. Only 10% of the TS player's salary counts against the salary cap. This enables teams to allow rookies, and 2nd and 3rd year players to develop into their potential before activating or cutting the player.
6. TS players can be traded.
7. Players on the TS may be cut at any point without salary cap penalty. It is the GM's responsibility to notify and validate the Commissioner removes the TS player without a salary cap penalty. **This notification to the Commissioner must be done within 2-days of being cut and submitted on the appropriate "Taxi Squad CUTS/DROPS" thread**. The salary cap penalty will remain for a team failing to notify the Commissioner of the cut.
8. GMs can activate and deactivate a TS eligible player **as often as they would like**.
9. Players, who are in their 4th season or beyond, are considered illegal if they are placed on the TS. MFL settings should enforce this rule, but If a team is found to have an illegal player on TS, the commissioners will cut the illegal player from the team's roster, and the team will incur the appropriate cap hit (50/75%). If the team moves the illegal player up to the active roster before it is discovered, there will be no repercussions.

Section 2.6: Taxi Squad Claims

TS Claim Key Date(s): Weekly (to include the off-season and regular season - postseason not included)

- Taxi Squad Claims open "new league year"
- TCL Offseason:
  - Claims open 24/7
  - Closed periods determined by the commissioner crew during auctions and drafts.
- Converts to weekly schedule on September 1st
- TCL Regular Season:
- Tuesday (3 pm ET) - (NFL Game Time): Teams can make claims on TS players
- At each players team's NFL Game Time, each player is locked for Claims and GM Promotion/Demotion
- End of TCL Regular Season: TS Claims are locked.
- Taxi Claims reopen March 1st.

Note –Teams currently receive compensation (draft pick/s) if their TS player is claimed by another team. <u>All claims are FINAL</u>.

1. Teams have the ability to claim TS players from other franchises in their conference.
2. The team claiming a TS player from an opposing team pays the compensation set below to the franchise losing the TS Player; one draft pick from the same round the player was drafted, one draft pick from the round after the player was drafted. Teams can use their picks from the next two seasons (if the **non-refundable** $75 fee has been paid) as compensation. *For example, picks from 2019 or 2020 can be used for a player claimed in 2019*. A team that is claiming the TS player may give up draft picks from an earlier round than what is required if they do not have the exact round of draft picks available. The compensation for an undrafted TS player (e.g. a player signed through free agency or the auction) will be a 7th round pick.

3. **Teams making a taxi claim are required to spend earlier year picks first.**
   For example: Team A claims a player with a 1st round value from Team B.
   If Team A has all of their 2019 & 2020 picks: *Team A must surrender 1st and 2nd round picks from 2019 as compensation.*
   If Team A only has their 2nd round pick in 2019, but all their picks in 2020*: They must surrender the 2nd round pick in 2019 and their 1st round pick in 2020.*

Player Drafted in X Round	TS Claim Compensation
1st Round	1st and 2nd round picks
2nd Round	2nd and 3rd round picks
3rd Round	3rd and 4th round picks
4th Round	4th and 5th round picks
5th Round	5th and 6th round picks
6th Round	6th and 7th round picks
7th Round	7th round pick
FA/UDFA	7th round pick

5. To claim TS players from an opposing team, the claiming team must post on the **Official TCL Taxi-Claim message board thread** declaring the transaction and **list the team, player, and the draft picks used as compensation** involved so all owners are notified. If a team owns multiple picks in the same round, the GM needs to specify which picks they are surrendering (their choice) in the message board thread.
6. Once a claim has been posted, the original owning team cannot promote the TS player nor can the team conduct any other action to retain the player. Other teams cannot make a claim on the same player.
7. The two teams involved must execute the transaction as a trade if: **the picks are valid, if all league fees for the draft pick years are paid, and if all roster requirements are met** (*Ex. roster position limits*). The TS claim is declared null and void if any of the conditions are not met.

Section 2.7: Injured Reserve (IR)

IR Key Dates:
Opens a week prior to Free Agency for fresh season ending injuries (prior season injuries do not count)
Opens for all IR players for the duration of the regular season (Sept-Dec)

1. Teams are allowed 50 IR spots.
2. Players declared to be on injured reserve by the official NFL injury report and MyFantasyLeague.com (MFL) injury designations can fill these positions. (Note: MFL is sometimes slow at assigning IR designations. TCL GM's can provide valid proof (provide a link) of the player's IR designation by the NFL and the Commissioner

can make the adjustment.)

Once a player is placed on the IR in the NFL, the TCL GM can choose to move that player to their IR. If the player in the NFL returns to the active roster at any point that season, the TCL GM will be given **3 days** to either move the activated player to their TCL active roster or drop the player and take the appropriate cap hits.

The following outlines eligibility for IR:

- Players placed on an NFL team's IR during the year are eligible for IR.
- Players who sustain a season ending injury in the offseason may be placed on IR *(1 week before FA)*
- Players who suffer season ending injuries who are then released with an injury settlement (*or similar)* prior to being put on the NFL team's IR are eligible for our IR.
- Players on the COVID list *(or similar)* during a Force Majeure year can be placed on IR.
- Players opting out due to COVID *(or similar)* during a Force Majeure year can be placed on IR.

3. Once the player is placed on the IR, only 25% of his salary counts towards the salary cap.
4. If a player is released from the IR, the team incurs the same salary penalty as if the player were on the Active Roster.
5. Trading players placed on the injured reserve list is allowed.
6. A team can place players on injured reserve at any time during the NFL regular season *(NFL weeks 1-16)*. To move a player to injured reserve, the owner must use the league's MFL website to process the transaction. Once a player is on the injured reserve list, the team may acquire a free agent to fill the empty roster spot on the active roster through the designated waiver wire processes (e.g. blind-bidding or FCFS).
7. On the new league year date, all IR players will be moved to the active roster.
8. **Special Player Situations:** A player that is on the suspended and/or non-football related injury lists **cannot** be placed on IR.
9. **Offseason IR:** Just prior to Free Agency, we will allow for any recent season ending injured players to be moved down to IR. The team must post to the Message Board with a credible news source.

Section 2.8: Retirements & Player Death

1. When a player retires from the NFL, the team has **1-month** to drop the player from the roster **without penalty**. After the 1-month deadline has passed, regular cut rules apply.

   If that player later announces a return to the NFL, the team retains the rights to the player under the conditions of his **original contract.** If the player's original contract had less than a full year left at the time of retirement, the player would become an unrestricted free agent (the team may not use a FT/TT).
   Example: Player on a 1 year contract (as of January 1st) retires from the NFL. The TCL team retires the player. A month later the player returns from retirement. Original team holds no rights to the unretired player.

   The team must decide within **1-week** of the player being reinstated whether to acquire the player again for the same contract terms as the player had prior to retiring or relinquish rights to the player.

   (**IMPORTANT:** For a player to be considered 'un-retired', there needs to be evidence that they either filed their reinstatement papers with the NFL league office or officially signed with a team. Merely considering coming out of retirement is not enough.)

   It is each team's individual responsibility to monitor their own retired players and to notify the Commissioner if they wish to reinstate a previously retired player. Once the 1-week period expires, the un-retired player will

become an TCL free agent and may be acquired by another team as per the usual free agency processes **(must pass through at least one blind bidding period - or - auction)**.
Example: In 2010, Brett Favre was signed to a 4 year contract. In 2011, Brett Favre retired from the NFL. In 2013, Brett Favre returned to the NFL, therefore the team owner who signed him to a 4 year deal still retains the rights to the player who will be in the 4th year of his original 4 year contract.

2. **Death of Player:** If a player passes away while under contract, this player is automatically dropped from their contract without salary cap penalty for the current and/or future seasons.
3. **Player Walks Away:** If a player decides to walk away from their NFL team without officially signing retirement papers, teams will be allowed to cut ties with the player and be relieved of future salary commitment. Current cap hits will still apply. The player must be on an NFL team to receive this cap relief. The player becomes a free agent and can be signed by any team.

   Teams are required to post to the message board their intent to move on from the player within 2 days (same as NFL early release) of the news in order to take the future cap relief. Must also include a link to a credible news source.

Section 2.9: Week 14 Bye Modifications

1. With the 18 game NFL schedule, our playoffs run weeks 14-17. Week 14 is the first week of our playoffs, and therefore, playoff teams with players who have their bye in week 14 will be at a disadvantage relative to other teams during this crucial part of the season.
2. In TCL we will be offering relief for teams that have week 14 byes. Every player MUST have ONE bye week during the season, however, if your player has a bye in week 14, you have the option to have the player serve their bye in week 13, and use their week 13 score as their score in week 14. In this way they will serve their bye, and be available to you in week 14 during the playoffs.
3. This will require that you post in this thread prior to kickoff of your player's game in week 13, and REMOVE the player from your week 13 starting lineup.
4. When you post in this thread, that player MUST/WILL START in week 14 (You are committing to starting them week 14 using their week 13 score)
5. Please plan ahead- I recommend posting as early as you are able, so that you can set a lineup before players are locked in or out of your lineup.
6. In week 14, you start the player on their bye, and then I will enter their week 13 score manually.
7. Owners will have to consider pros/cons of taking a bye in week 13, that might cost you a playoff position or even making the playoffs vs missing a key player in week 14 during the playoffs.

   Process for modifying your Week 14 bye players

   - Post player's names on the appropriate MFL Message Board thread prior to kick off of their week 13 game, which indicates your intention to serve the player's bye in week 13. Posts don't become official until indicated player's game has kicked off, if you need to change players or remove one, please use an entirely new post, no editing on this thread.
   - No removing players once their Week 13 games have started, they are locked in for a Week 14 replacement.
   - REMOVE the player from your week 13 lineup, if not, they are voided from any Week 14 bye modifications
   - Start the player on a bye in week 14 (if you post, you MUST START the player in week 14)
   - Commissioners will manually enter the player's week 13 score for week 14 before the kickoff of week 14

ARTICLE 3 – ROSTER MANAGEMENT

Section 3.1: Salary Cap

2025 Salary Key Dates:
Jan 1st - March - Soft cap
April - December Hard cap enforced

- The TCL cap will mirror the NFL's salary cap. For 2025, the cap is set to **$279.2** million.

- The salary cap is a hard cap through the TCL regular season & playoffs (April-December 31st)
- The salary cap will be a soft cap from January 1st to March 31st, allowing teams to exceed the salary cap for trading purposes. However, teams must be under the next season's salary cap by March 31st.

  In the new TCL league year, or when the NFL implements their new salary cap, the league implements a salary cap increase that matches the NFL's salary cap.

- The TCL minimum player salary is set to match the NFL veteran minimum for the current season. For 2025, the NFL veteran minimum is **$1.170m**.
- The TCL minimum rookie player salary is set to match the NFL rookie minimum for the current season. For 2025, the NFL rookie minimum is **$840k**.

#CS	2022	2023	2024	2025	2026	2027	2028	2029	2030
0	$705	$750	$795	$840	$855	$930	$975	$1,020	$1,056
1	$825	$870	$915	$960	$1,005	$1,050	$1,095	$1,140	$1,185
2	$895	$940	$985	$1,030	$1,075	$1,120	$1,165	$1,210	$1,255
3	$965	$1,010	$1,055	$1,100	$1,145	$1,190	$1,235	$1,280	$1,325
4-6	$1,035	$1,080	$1,125	$1,170	$1,215	$1,260	$1,305	$1,350	$1,395
7+	$1,120	$1,165	$1,210	$1,255	$1,300	$1,135	$1,390	$1,435	$1,480

(all ammounts in thousands of dollars)
(CS = Credited Seasons)

Section 3.2: Contract Basics

1. A player's contract consists of his yearly salary and the number of years he will be under contract.
2. The minimum contract length is 1-year and the maximum length is 4-years. This applies to players acquired during the free agent auctions in the off-season.
3. Teams retain the rights to a player from year to year as long as the player has 1-4 years remaining on his contract length.
4. Each player's salary increases by 12.5% each season.
5. All players on the roster will have their contract reduced by 1-year on the new league year date.

6. In the event that an NFL season is not played due to CBA hangups, pandemic, or other unforeseen reason; contracts would freeze. (No year reduction & no additional 12.5% increase)
7. Following an auction, contracts must be established by the deadline *(see league calendar)*. GMs will provide their contracts through the Official TCL Free Agent Contract Listing message board, per conference. Failure to announce a player's contract length by the deadline results in an automatic one-year contract.

Section 3.3: Rookie Contracts

1. All rookie salaries are predetermined, based on their selection in the rookie draft. [Please see Article 4, Section 3: Rookie Draft Pay Scale for more information.]
2. All rookies automatically sign a **4-year** contract.
3. Players on rookie contracts (RC) may **not** be extended at **any point** of their contract. However, they can be franchise tagged and tendered at the **very end** of the contract.
4. If a player, who is on his rookie contract, is cut at any point, the next contract he signs will not be considered a rookie contract.
5. Rookies drafted in the first round have a built-in 5th year option.

Section 3.4: Fifth Year Option

1. Rookies drafted in the first round have a built-in 5th year option which results in a 100% pay increase should the owner exercise the option. The annual 12.5% **does not** apply. It is up to the GM to notify the league of their intent to apply the 5th year option.
2. 5th Year Option: If a team opts to exercise the 5th year option on an expiring 1st round pick. That player would become an Unrestricted Free Agent following the 5th year option year (no tenders allowed beyond this point, but can still franchise/transition tag).
3. Once rookie contracts expire, the players will head to free agency barring a rookie tender/5th-year-option/franchise/transition tag being applied.
4. Players who have had the 5th year option applied may be traded.

Section 3.5: RFA Rookie Contract Tenders

1. Each team will be allowed to place a tender on 2 expiring rookie contracts each off-season.
2. Only rookies coming off a drafted rookie contract are eligible to tender.
3. Each team may only use one of each tender type (Can't use two 1st round tenders, etc).
4. The tender round/type just dictates the value of the deal you are offering and the compensation you will receive if you choose not to match a high bid.
5. The opening bid salary percentages are based on the salary cap for the recently completed season. *(2020 offseason tender amounts are determined by 2019 salary cap)*
6. In order to be eligible for a rookie tender, the player would have to have been on the tendering team's roster for the entirety of the previous (recently completed) regular season (September-December).
7. A player coming off the 5th year option is not eligible for a rookie tender.
8. Tendered players may be traded prior to the auction. The tender is included in the trade and may not be used again by the original team to tender another player. The new team may choose to rescind the tender so long as it doesn't void the original trade *(can't trade something for nothing)*. If rescinded, the new team may not reapply the traded-for-tender to another player. The new team may also not apply one of their own tenders to a player they traded for as that player was not on their roster all year *(see 5 above)*.

The tender options are as follows:

A) First-round tender: Free agents can negotiate with other teams, but the original team has the option to match any deal and will receive a first-round selection if it opts not to match the deal.

- *First Round Tender Amount = 7.5% of the salary cap*
- *[Example: 2025 cap 279.2m, the tender amount would be $20,940,000]*

B) Second-round tender: Free agents can negotiate with other teams, but the original team has the option to match any deal and will receive a second-round selection if it opts not to match the deal.

- *Second Round Tender Amount = 3.75% of the salary cap*
- *[Example: 2025 cap 279.2m, the tender amount would be $10,470,000]*

C) Third-round tender: Free agents can negotiate with other teams, but the original team has the option to match any deal and will receive a third-round selection if it opts not to match the deal.

- *Third Round Tender Amount = 1% of the salary cap*
- *Example: 2025 cap 279.2m, the tender amount would be $2,792,000*

RFA Auction

1. We will hold a separate auction in MFL for restricted free agents. Each player will be placed into the auction with the tender designation applied at the starting bid amount. Teams are then allowed to place bids similar to our other tag auctions. Original team would have the ability to match or accept compensation (dependent on which tender was used).
2. In order to bid, **teams are required to have the correct current year draft pick compensation available**.
3. An auction will be held in a week consisting of only RFA tendered players. The auction will use actual/real bids over proxy ones, with a resetting 14-hour clock. Bids will be in 100k increments.
4. When a team makes a bid on a tagged/tendered player... the team ***MUST*** include which pick is being used in the bid comment section (***FOR EVERY BID***). The designated pick is locked in and immovable (can't be traded or used to bid on another player) until the auction is complete or until another team takes over as high bidder.
5. Extensions: The same extension rules apply following a winning RFA auction. 5-10% discounts for long-term deals.

RFA Tendered Player Auction

A. The opening bid for each player is based on the draft round tender that was placed on them *(see above).*
B. An auction will be held on MFL consisting of only tendered players. The auction will use actual/real bids over proxy ones, with a resetting 14-hour clock. Bids will be in 100k increments.
C. Bids are not allowed to exceed the salary cap.
D. Teams are not allowed to bid on more players than they have appropriate draft picks for. *(Can only be "winning" as many auctions as you have appropriate picks for)*
E. Any "illegal" bids will not be honored.
F. Bidding teams must include which pick is being used in the bid comments.
G. During RFA bidding, if a player receives a bid, the original GM can decide to decline the bid immediately - accepting the current draft pick. However, once the original GM posts his decision to decline, he cannot go back and change that decision.

H. If the original GM declines to match a high bid mid-auction and accepts a draft pick, they are able to use it to bid on other RFA players immediately.

Accept/decline offer

1. If any bids take place, the owner of the franchised player must match the winning bid or decline to match the offer by the deadline.

a. GMs declining to match the high bid will accept draft pick compensation at the round the RFA player was tendered.

b. If a GM declines to match the current high bid ***during the RFA tender auction***, they may enter the auction as a bidder using the draft pick that they will receive..

2. If no bids are received for the tendered player, the original team will keep the player at the opening bid amount *(The team may still determine the contract length, utilizing the 5%-10% discounts for long term deals).*

Contract Extension for RFA Tendered Player

1. The team receiving the player can opt to extend the tentative 1-year agreement. The salary amount is determined by the winning bid. If the player receives a 2-year contract extension, the player's salary will be reduced by 5%. If a player receives a 3-4 year extension, the player's salary will be reduced by 10%.

Section 3.6: Contract Extensions

1. Teams can extend any player who has surpassed 50% of their assigned contract, and not on a RC, during the off-season (April-September).
    - Player on a 2 year contract: Eligible to extend after their 1st season(50%) if they don't holdout.
    - Player on a 3 year contract: Eligible to extend after their 2nd season(66%) if they don't holdout.
    - Player on a 4 year contract: Eligible to extend after their 2nd season(50%) if they don't holdout.
2. When extending a contract, the current salary at the time is increased by 12.5% and becomes the new salary for the current year. This effectively creates a "double" hit in terms of salary inflation, which is the price paid for extending a contract without allowing the player to test free agency. If a team wants to extend a player's contract he must post the extension in the **Official Contract Extension** message board and then verify that the Commissioner makes the correct extension and salary increase. The owner must provide the Commissioner with the player's name and the new contract length. Once the Commissioner has received all of the information necessary, the Commissioner will perform the contract extension calculation and the new contract value updated on the league's website within a week. If an owner fails to submit a contract extension by the deadline to the Commissioner, the player will remain under the current contract.
3. Players on rookie contracts may not be extended at any point *(they may be tendered/tagged).*
4. Coaches and Team Offenses are ineligible to be extended.

Section 3.7: Early Release (Cut)

2025 Early Release (Cut) Key Date(s):

- January to Cutdown day: **50%** cut penalty for current season
- Regular Season to Playoffs: **75%** cut penalty for current season

1. Players released by their franchise prior to their contract expiring will incur penalties. The severity of the penalty varies with the length of the contract remaining. **Note: Both Franchise tagged and Transition tagged players' contracts are fully guaranteed for the first year of the franchise/transition tagged contract. (100% cut penalty for the current year. For the remaining years, refer to the charts below.)**

Cut Penalty Chart - TCL Off-Season
When a player who has a multi-year contract is cut during the **off-season**, the current season salary is paid at **50%**. In the following year, part of the contract is still owed to the cut player (Cut Penalty Cost). Depending on the amount of years left, the Cut Penalty in the following year is determined by the following:
● If 2-years remain on the contract, 40% of the current salary is paid in the following year

● If 3-years remain on the contract, 60% of the current salary is paid in the following year
● If 4-years remain on the contract, 80% of the current salary is paid in the following year.

As an example, the off-season has just begun. A team decides to cut Adrian Peterson, whose salary is $100,000, and has 3 years left on the contract. The cap hit (50% of $100,000) results in Adrian Peterson costing $50,000 in dead money this year. Since there were 3 years remaining when the cancellation took place, 55% of that $100,000 salary amount is considered dead money the following year ($55,000).

Cut Penalty Chart – TCL Regular Season
When a player who has a multi-year contract is cut during the **regular season**, the current season salary is paid at **75%**. In the following year, part of the contract is still owed to the cut player (Cut Penalty Cost). Depending on the amount of years left, the Cut Penalty in the following year is determined by the following:
● If 2-years remain on the contract, 40% of the current salary is paid in the following year
● If 3-years remain on the contract, 60% of the current salary is paid in the following year
● If 4-years remain on the contract, 80% of the current salary is paid in the following year.

As an example, it is October 1st, the season is in full swing. A team decides to cut Adrian Peterson, whose salary is $100,000, and has 3 years left on the contract. The cap hit (75% of $100,000) results in Adrian Peterson costing $75,000 in dead money this year. Since there were 3 years remaining when the cancellation took place, 60% of that $100,000 salary amount is considered dead money the following year ($60,000).

Note – Remember that by cutting a player, the annual 12.5% increase does NOT occur, so there are pros and cons to cutting a player early in his contract.

NFL Released/Cut Player(s): (Note - This applies to each position except for Team Offense.**)**

1. If a player is released (cut) from his NFL team, he may be released immediately. The team would receive the current cut penalty, but would not have to pay for future years if the player was signed to a multi-year contract. *For example, Joseph Randle was signed to a $100,000, 3-year contract. His NFL team cut him in week 3, so his TCL team could do the same. The TCL team would receive a $75,000 cut penalty for the current season, but would not have to pay for any additional contract years.*
2. To drop/cut a player who was recently cut by his NFL team, the TCL team must post to the **Official NFL Player Early-Release** message board thread within **2-days** of being cut to inform the Commissioner. The message board post must also include a link to a credible source that the player was cut/released in the NFL. Recommendations include: NFL.com, ESPN.com, Rotoworld.com, or Spotrac.com.
3. This doesn't apply to players who have had their NFL contracts expire. Also, this does not apply if a TCL team acquired the player while he is an NFL free agent.
4. If an NFL team releases a player early during our playoffs and rosters are locked, you must still post to the message board with your intentions even if your roster is locked.

TCL Free Agents (Released after free agent auction)

1. When a player is released from a TCL team, they will be locked until the following Tuesday 'Blind Bidding' waiver period. During Blind Bidding, the highest blind bid will win the rights to the player (bidding starts at veteran minimum). If they clear blind bidding, they will become available on First Come First Serve waivers.
2. Their contract years will be defaulted to 1-year and their salary will be defaulted to veteran minimum. C. Any rookies who were acquired in either the draft, or the UDFA auction whose salaries are below veteran minimum, will be set to veteran minimum. For example, if a team had signed a rookie for 465k in the UDFA auction and released them, that player would be eligible for veteran minimum in blind bidding/FCFS.

Section 3.8: Waiver Wire

2025 Waiver Wire Process Key Date(s):

- August: Only way to procure MFL Free Agent players during NFL pre-season will be the UDFA/Second Veteran FA Auction that runs the whole length of August.
- September - Completion of NFL week 13: Regular season weekly waiver wire process (Blind Bidding & FCFS). Waiver wire process ends for non-playoff teams.
- Completion of NFL week 17: Waiver wire process ends for the season.

1. GMs are only able to use the available funds that have not been allotted to players on their roster or through salary adjustments.

Waiver Wire Process:

2025 regular season waiver wire process key date(s): September - Completion of NFL week 17

- Wednesday (7 pm EST): Blind bids are processed.
- Wednesday (7:45 pm EST) - Monday (9pm EST): First-come, first-serve waivers
- Note - Waivers will run on Wednesday on Thanksgiving week at 7 pm ET, FCFS at 7: 45 pm ET.

1. Once the regular season starts, you can obtain free agents through two methods: blind bidding and first-come, first serve (FCFS).
2. All options occur weekly during the regular season.
3. You can submit your blind bid between Tuesday (10am EST) and Wednesday (6:59:59 pm EST). The bids are conducted on the MFL league page. Player's salaries are determined by the high-bidder. Blind bids are not setup as a proxy bid, meaning the amount you enter for your bid is what will be given as the player's salary if you win. [You can find more information about MFL's Blind Bidding process in their Blind Bidding Help Center.]
4. First-come, first-served is conducted from Wednesday (7:45 pm EST) to Monday (9pm EST). Players unable to be claimed at/after the kickoff of their game. Players' salaries will be set to the veteran minimum.
5. All players acquired through blind bidding or first-come, first-served will automatically sign a 1-year contract.
6. If there are no "limited players" (PK/PN/Coach/OFF) available due to them being locked (recently dropped), we will unlock them in a pinch.

Section 3.9: Franchise Tags (FT)

1. During the off-season, a team may choose to retain up to one impending free agent by using a franchise tag. The GM must notify the Commissioner of the **opposite** conference of their Franchise Tag intentions by the deadline *(GMs will submit their tagged player to a commissioner)*. A player may only be tagged a **total of 3 times** in his TCL career. Coaches and Team Offense are ineligible to receive a franchise tag.
2. In order to qualify for the franchise tag, the player must: be on the owner's roster during the recently completed season, the player's contract will expire in the new league year, the player was not acquired during the TCL Playoffs, and the player hasn't previously received the franchise tag **three-times**.
3. To be eligible to bid on a franchise tagged player, a team must own a **current** 1st round draft pick.
4. Players signed during the TCL playoffs are **ineligible** for a franchise tag.
5. Players on contracts week 1, and cut from a team are **ineligible** for a franchise tag for that season.
6. The first year of a Franchise Tagged player's contract is **fully guaranteed**. If the player is released early, the cut penalty is 100% for the current year. If the player is signed to a multi-year deal, a subsequent cut penalty will apply the following year. [For multi-year contracts please refer to the charts in Section 3.5.]

Apply the Franchise Tag

1. By the deadline specified, GMs must notify the commissioner of their intent to apply the franchise tag..
2. The player tentatively signs a 1 year deal at the average annual salary of the top 10 player contracts at his position in their conference OR 12.5% salary increase, whichever is greater.

3. The league will be notified of all franchise tags via message board.

Tag and Trade

1. Teams are allowed to 'Tag and Trade' Franchise Tagged players (before, during, & after the auction). A team may **not** use another Franchise Tag once it has applied and traded it's tag. The Franchise Tag is essentially included in the trade.
2. Teams are not restricted as to how many Franchise Tagged players they are allowed to trade for.
3. Teams **are** allowed to rescind a tag on a tagged player they traded for, but may **not** reapply that tag to one of their own players and likewise may not apply their own tag to the traded for player *(can't trade for a transition tagged player, rescind, and then apply own franchise tag)*.

Rescind the Franchise Tag

1. Before the franchise tag auction begins, GMs will have an opportunity to rescind the franchise tag if they no longer wish to retain the rights to the franchise tagged player. Franchise tags must be rescinded before the franchise tag bidding period begins.
2. GMs must notify the commish of their intent to rescind the tag.
3. GMs may reapply their own franchise tag to another player after it has been rescinded, but may not reapply a franchise tag that is not their own (one they traded for).

Franchise Tag Auction

1. The bidding will start at the average of the top-10 highest paid players at the franchise tag player's position in their conference OR 12.5% salary increase, whichever is greater.
2. An auction will be held on MFL consisting of only franchise tagged players. The auction will use actual/real bids (not proxy bids), with a resetting 14-hour clock. Bids will be in $100k increments.
3. When a team makes a bid on a tagged/tendered player... the team ***MUST*** include which pick is being used in the bid comment section (***FOR EVERY BID***). [Note - If a GM places a bid WITHOUT designating a draft pick, that bid is considered unofficial. The GM will be required to up the bid $100k & designate the draft pick in the comments for it to be official. If an auction ends on an unofficial bid, the previous official bid/pick will be the ending price/offer.]
4. The designated pick is locked in and immovable (can't be traded or used to bid on another player) until the auction is complete or until another team takes over as high bidder. A team may not change the draft pick in their bid with a new bid of their own unless another team first becomes the high bidder.
5. Teams are not allowed to bid on players if the franchised player will put the bidding team over the hard cap. Teams are also not allowed to bid on more players than they have current 1st round picks for. *(Can only be "winning" as many auctions as you have a current 1st round pick for)* Any "illegal" bids will not be honored.

Accept/decline offer

If any bids take place, the owner of the franchised player must match the winning bid or decline to match the offer by the deadline.

1. GMs declining to match the offer will accept compensation of the 1st round draft pick mentioned in the highest bid comment for the franchise tagged player.
2. If a GM declines to match the current high bid ***during the franchise tag auction***, they may choose to accept the current pick and may enter the auction as a bidder..
3. If a GM doesn't provide an answer to match/decline an offer by the deadline, the lack of response will be a "decline" and the player will go to the highest bidder.

If no bids are received for the tagged player, the original team will keep the player at the opening bid amount *with a 1 year deal.*

Contract Extension for Franchise Tagged Player

1. If the player has been bid on, the team receiving the franchised player can opt to extend the tentative 1-year agreement. The salary amount is determined by the winning bid. If the player receives a 2-year

contract extension, the player's salary will be reduced by 5%. If a player receives a 3-4 year extension, the player's salary will be reduced by 10%. The first year of the contract is still 100% guaranteed and cut penalties apply to future years [For multi-year contracts please refer to the charts in Section 3.5.].

Section 3.10: Transition Tags (TT)

1. During the offseason a team is eligible to use 2 total tags(between Franchise and Transition). If a GM chooses to use the Franchise Tag, then they are limited to 1 Transition Tags. If the team doesn't use the Franchise Tag, they can use one Transition Tag option if they so choose to do so or two of the same one, or anything in between.
2. Coaches and Team Offense are ineligible to receive a transition tag.
3. Transition tags **can** be applied to the same player two years in a row as long as they choose a higher transition tag option then the previous year.
4. To be eligible to bid on a transition tagged player, a team must own the appropriate draft picks before the auction starts.
5. Players signed during the TCL playoffs are **ineligible** for a transition tag.
6. Players on contracts week 1, and cut from a team are **ineligible** for a transition tag for that season.
7. The first year of a Transition Tagged player's contract is **fully guaranteed**. If the player is released early, the cut penalty is 100% for the current year. If the player is signed to a multi-year deal, a subsequent cut penalty will apply the following year. [For multi-year contracts please refer to the charts in Section 3.5.]
8. The transition tag process will follow the NFL's procedures, which are:
    a. Original owning team applies the transition tag
    b. The other conference teams have the ability to bid on the player.
    c. The original owning team can accept/decline the new contract demands.

Transition Tag 1

1. The salary of a transition 1 tagged player will be equal to the average salary of the Top 30 paid players at their position; or 112.5% of the player's current salary, whichever is greater.
2. The winning bidder will compensate with a 2nd round pick from the current draft calendar or a 3rd from the current and a 2nd from following years draft class.

Transition Tag 2

1. The salary of a transition 2 tagged player will be equal to the average salary of the Top 60 paid players at their position; or 112.5% of the player's current salary, whichever is greater.
2. The winning bidder will compensate with a 3rd round pick from the current draft calendar or a 4th from the current and a 3rd from following years draft class.

Transition Tag 3

1. The salary of a transition 3 tagged player will be equal to the average salary of the Top 90 paid players at their position; or 112.5% of the player's current salary, whichever is greater.
2. The winning bidder will compensate with a 4th round pick from the current draft calendar or a 5th from the current and a 4th from following years draft class.

Apply the Transition Tag

1. By the deadline specified, GMs must notify the commissioner of their intent to apply the transition tag.
2. The player tentatively signs a 1 year deal at the average annual salary of the top X player contracts at his position in their conference OR 12.5% salary increase, whichever is greater.
3. The league will be notified of all transition tags via message board.

Tag and Trade

1. Teams are allowed to 'Tag and Trade' Transition Tagged players (before, during, & after the auction). A team may not use another Transition Tag once it has applied and traded its tag. The Transition Tag is essentially included in the trade.
2. Teams are not restricted as to how many Transition Tagged players they are allowed to trade for.
3. Teams **are** allowed to rescind a tag on a tagged player they traded for, but may **not** reapply that tag to one of their own players and likewise may not apply their own tag to the traded for player *(can't trade for a transition tagged player, rescind, and then apply own franchise tag)*

Rescind the Transition Tag

1. Before the transition tag auction begins, GMs will have an opportunity to rescind the transition tag if they no longer wish to retain the rights to the transition tagged player. Transition tags must be rescinded before the transition tag bidding period begins.
2. GMs must notify the commish of their intent to rescind the tag.
3. GMs may reapply their own transition tag to another player after it has been rescinded, but may not reapply a transition tag that is not their own (one they traded for).

Transition Tag Auction

1. We will hold a live auction for all transition tagged players (following the franchise tag auction).
2. Actual/real bids over proxy ones, with a resetting 14 hour clock. Bids will be in 100k increments.
3. Once the auction is completed, the original team will have the option to match the winning bid.

Accept/Decline Winning Bid

If any bids take place, the owner of the transitioned player must match the winning bid or decline to match the offer by the deadline.

1. GMs declining to match the offer will accept compensation of the appropriate round draft pick mentioned in the highest bid comment for the transition tagged player.
2. If a GM declines to match the current high bid ***during the franchise tag auction***, they may choose to accept the current pick and may enter the auction as a bidder..
3. If a GM doesn't provide an answer to match/decline an offer by the deadline, the lack of response will be a "decline" and the player will go to the highest bidder.

Contract Extension for Transition Tagged Player

1. If a player isn't bid on they aren't eligible to be extended using the following formulas.
2. If a player was bidded on, either GM involved that retains or is given rights to the player are eligible to use the following formulas.
3. The team receiving the transition player can opt to extend the tentative 1-year agreement. The salary amount is determined by the winning bid. If the player receives a 2 year contract extension, the player's salary will be reduced by 5%. If a player receives a 3-4 year extension, the player's salary will be reduced by 10%. The first year of the contract is still 100% guaranteed and cut penalties apply to future years [For multi-year contracts please refer to the charts in Section 3.5.].

Section 3.11: Waiver Extension Tags

2026 Waiver Extension Tag Key Date(s):

- Declarations Due by: February, TBD 2026

- To be eligible for the Waiver Extension Tag, a player must be acquired by Blind Bid or FCFS Waivers between September 1st - End of Week 13 Waivers (Monday night)

1. During the off-season a team may choose to retain **2** current season waiver pickups that are pending free agents by using a waiver extension tag. The GM must post to the Official Waiver Tag message board with their intentions.
2. Teams may extend the player for an additional one, two, three, or four year contract.
3. The current salary for a waiver extension is increased by 12.5% and becomes the new salary for the **upcoming season**.
4. Players signed off waivers during the TCL playoffs are not eligible to be tagged.
5. Players who are on a roster after September 1st, and are then cut by a team in-season (Sep-Nov) are ineligible for waiver tag by **any** team.

Section 3.12: Two Tier Player Holdouts

2026 Player Holdout Key Date(s):

- Declarations Due by: TBD 2026

1. Holdouts are conducted to bring top-ranked, scoring players at their position into line with their peers.
2. **Holdout Immunity** – A player may not holdout three years in a row. Players on TCL rookie contracts (e.g. any player who is drafted in an TCL rookie draft) are immune from holdouts for the length of their rookie contract. 5th year option included (1st round picks).
3. The holdout player can be traded during the designated trading period. If the owner trades a holdout player, the holdout must first be accepted or is assumed to be accepted. A team may not trade something for a holdout player and then decline the holdout as that could result in a trade of something for nothing.
4. Holdout position is based on the position the player was listed at during the season he met top-xx in scoring. [For example, Player A meets top-16 in scoring at the DE position in 2020. During the off-season of 2021, Player A is moved from DE to DT. The position the holdout salary is based upon is from the 2020 season as that's where the player met the holdout criteria.] This is particularly important to note in our true-position IDP format.
5. A player will hold out if he meets all of the following requirements:

Position	Holdout <if finish is>	1st Holdout (1:3) <and pay is>	2nd Holdout (1:2) <and pay is>
QB	>= top 8	<= top 24	<= top 16
RB	>= top 10	<= top 30	<= top 20
WR	>= top 12	<= top 36	<= top 24
TE	>= top 6	<= top 18	<= top 12
DT	>= top 6	<= top 18	<= top 12
DE	>= top 8	<= top 24	<= top 16
LB	>= top 10	<= top 30	<= top 20
CB	>= top 6	<= top 18	<= top 12
S	>= top 6	<= top 18	<= top 12

Player Holdout chart

1. The player must finish the season in the top-xx in scoring at his position (see the table above). Statistics are based on the total points earned between weeks 1-17 of the NFL using our scoring system in MFL.
2. **The player's current salary must be less than the average of the top-y highest paid players at his position.**
    1. **For the first year holdout, a QB for example must finish top 8 -and- be paid less than the average of the top 24 (1:3 ratio). If the QB finishes top 8, but already gets paid greater than the top 24 average, they fail to holdout, but it will still be considered as a holdout attempt.**
    2. **For a second consecutive holdout, a QB must finish top 8 -and- be paid less than the average of the top 16 (1:2 ratio). Regardless if the second holdout attempt is successful or not, the QB is ineligible to holdout again the 3rd year in a row.**
3. Top highest salaries will be based on week 1 salaries. This will also consider the 7.5% salary increase in the next season for the player in question, however that will not be considered for the averages. *For example, to determine the position averages going into the 2021 off-season, the top-xx highest paid at the position is averaged based on their week 1 salary in 2020. If the potential holdout player's salary in 2021(including the 7.5% salary increase) is still less than 2020 average, he qualifies for a holdout.*
4. The player didn't hold out the previous two years. A player is not eligible for holdout three years in a row.
5. The player is not currently on a Rookie Contract (RC).
6. The player's position is based on the season that just completed.
   (ex. Irrelevant if a player changes from DE to DT after the season)
7. The player is still under contract for the upcoming season.

6. If the player meets the above requirements, his team has two options to resolve the holdout:

    1. **<u>Accept the new contract demands for his holdout year.</u>** The GM may choose to accept the player's new contract demands. **The player then signs a new contract with a salary equal to the average salary of the top-yy highest paid players at his position; effective at the start of the new league year** (annual 7.5% increase does not take effect). The length of the new contract (1-4 years) is solely at the owner's discretion.
    2. **Reject the new contract demands.** The GM may choose to release the player prior to the holdout deadline without a salary cap penalty. The player will be free to sign with any team in free agency. If the holdout demands are rejected, the player will be eligible to holdout in the next season if he meets the requirements again.
    3. **Holdout decisions can not be rescinded.**

Section 3.13: Trades

Section 3.13 a: Player Trades

2025 Trade key date(s):

- Thursday following the Completion of **NFL Week 11 games - 6pm EST** - Trade deadline (Moved to "Stat Correction Thursday"). The deadline to pay for the ability to trade future draft picks is the same day as the trade deadline.

- 2026 Trade Deadline - **Thursday, November TBD @ 6pm EST**

1. Trading is allowed during the off-season and regular season leading up to the trade deadline. Trading will reopen once league fees are collected for the following year.
2. **Trading players across conferences is not allowed.**
3. Trades can involve players, draft picks and salary cap. GM's are responsible to ensure the trade does not place the team over the salary cap or roster limits.
4. Reference Section 3.13b for all details pertaining to trading Salary Cap.
5. Teams cannot conduct a trade without including a player, draft pick or salary cap consideration. *For example, Team A cannot send players or draft picks and Team B does not include a player or draft pick*. The only exception to this rule is if a player is illegally on the TS, in which a GM can acquire the player without any compensation.
6. If any future draft picks are traded, the GM must pay $ towards that season's league fee (which is **non-refundable** if the GM leaves the league). **The deadline for paying towards future picks will be determined based around the NFL trade deadline**.
7. If a GM desires to trade the following year's picks, the GM will have to pay $150 towards that year's league fee. *For Example, in the 2020 season, if you trade any 2021 draft picks, $150 of the 2021 league fee is required to process the trade(which is **non-refundable** if the GM leaves the league).*
8. If a GM desires to trade picks two year's out, the GM will have to pay the $300 league fee for the next year and $150 towards the league fee two years out. *For example in the 2020 season, if you trade any 2020 draft picks, $300 of the 2021 league fee and $150 of the 2022 league fee is required to process the trade(also **non-refundable** if the GM leaves the league).*

    - If the team, which included future draft picks, does not pay their $ within 3-days of the trade being accepted, the other team can decide to wait for the payment OR have the trade voided.
    - For the team who didn't pay the $ to trade future picks, the assets involved in the trade will be frozen (player(s) and draft pick(s) cannot be traded, dropped, or used) until payment is complete.
    - In the event that the draft involving the frozen draft picks begins, the picks will be discarded.

9. All contracts are attached to the player(s) involved in the trade.
10. Teams under new ownership are not allowed to trade for their first 7-days in the league. This is to give the new GM time to become accustomed to the league rules, scoring system, and team needs.
11. Some recommendations for trades are as follows:
    - You should check your trade offers every time you log onto the league website. If the offer is not acceptable, reject it immediately. Communication is the lifeblood of all fantasy leagues so it's common courtesy to explain why. Also, some owners may send you repeated trade offers, but if you explain that you are not interested in a player or trade options, then the GM may stop the repeated trade offers.
    - You are expected to be respectful in response to all trade offers you receive. Despite what you may think, it's a rarity that offers are meant to insult you or your intelligence. Rather, teams have a habit of starting their negotiations in a lowball fashion hoping to meet somewhere in the middle. Or, other GMs might just value players differently than you. Either way, showing respect to other GMs in the league is vital to the league and to your future trading relations.

Section 3.14b: Trading Salary Cap

1. TCL authorizes GMs to use Salary Cap as a negotiating tool to make trades.
2. Trades involving Salary Cap need another entity in return like players and/or picks.
3. Any team receiving a Salary Cap adjustment in the positive or negative cannot surpass 10% in that direction.
    a. League year 2025: 10% cap number - $27.92m

    b. After calculating a GMs cap adjustments they cannot accumulate to $27.92m in the negative or positive.
4. The minimum amount that can be traded cannot be less than the rookie minimum during that league year.

Section 3.14: Challenging Trades

Trading is part of the fun of fantasy football. There are lots of strong opinions one way or the other on trading.

1. Any team (including the Commissioner) can object to a trade by posting in the league message boards. The objection must be posted within 48-hours of a trade. The team must fully state their reason for the objection, which details why the trade should be reviewed and possibly overturned. All teams have the right to post their thoughts on the trade in question in a civil manner.
2. If a second objection is received within 24 hours, the Commissioner will push the objection to a vote by the Conference not involved with the trade to receive a final ruling. The voting will last for 24 hours. If the voting ends in a tie, the trade will be blocked.
3. A team may not challenge its own trade.

Section 3.15: Player Position Eligibility

A player's position may change multiple times in a given year. In order to address this, there are a couple things to consider:

- MFL may automatically switch a player's position if they are moved to a different position on their actual NFL team. MFL places a player at a position based on Fantasy Sharks. *(Ex. You have signed Jadeveon Clowney (TEN) as your starting DE, but Mike Vrabel has other plans for him and moves him to LB. MFL may adjust his position to LB to match his position in the NFL.)*
- If a player is moved to a different position and MFL **does not** make the adjustment, you can have the player's position adjusted by the TCL Commissioner for your conference by posting to the Official Player Position Change message board thread. You must provide an article that **clearly** states that the player is currently playing a different position from what the player is designated as in MFL.

ARTICLE 4 – TCL AUCTIONS AND DRAFTS OVERVIEWS

Section 4.1: TCL Coaches & Team OFF Auction

2025 TCL Coaches/OFF Auction key date(s):

- **2025: TBD**
- Late June/Early July

- **2026 and beyond**
- March TBD, 2026 12 pm EDT to March TBD

Coach/OFF Free Agent Slow-Auction (Coaches & OFF only)

- Bids will be made in increments of $100.
- Auction is open for 1-week, depending on the rate of activity.
- Each conference conducts a separate auction since trades cannot occur between the two conferences.

- This is a slow-auction where a coach or offense will be on the bidding floor for 14-hours. If the high bidder changes, the timer starts over. [Depending on the speed of the auction, the timer may be reduced.]
- Teams are ONLY able to acquire coaches & Team OFF.
- Coaches/OFF acquired through the auction cannot be cut and resigned by the same team who cut them during the same auction. [For example, a team cannot win Don Shula, cut him, then sign him again in the same auction that he was originally acquired.]
- You are not required to acquire a coach or offense in this auction. Leftovers will be available in regular free agency.
- GMs will have to specify each acquired coach or offense's contract length (1-4 years) within 48-hours of the end of the auction by using the Official Contract thread on the message board.
- If coaches or offenses are acquired through this auction and are cut prior to September 5th (6pm EST), the coach/OFF is cut at 60% of his salary and the team **must pay the next season cut fee** if he is signed to a multi-year contract. (see Section 3.5: Early Release Cuts)

Section 4.2: TCL Franchise Tag Auction

2026 TCL Franchise Tag Auction key date(s):

- Noon on First Saturday in April 2026

Auction Details:

- Start date/time: **April TBD, 2026**
- End date/time: When activity stops
- Players will be placed up for auction via TCL MFL site
- Timer: 14-hour clock; clock restarts when high-bidder changes
- Bids: Actual bids (not using proxy bids)
- Increase amount: $100k
- Requirement to bid: In order to bid, the team **must own** a current year (*2025) 1st round pick

Bid Process:

- When a team makes a bid on a tagged/tendered player... the team ***MUST*** include which pick is being used in the bid comment section (***FOR EVERY BID***). [Note - If a GM places a bid WITHOUT designating a draft pick, that bid is considered unofficial. The GM will be required to up the bid $100k & designate the draft pick in the comments for it to be official. If an auction ends on an unofficial bid, the previous official bid/pick will be the ending price/offer.]
- The designated pick is locked in and immovable (can't be traded or used to bid on another player) until the auction is complete or until another team takes over as high bidder. A team may not change the draft pick in their bid with a new bid of their own unless another team first becomes the high bidder.
- Teams are not allowed to bid on players if the franchised player will put the bidding team over the hard cap. Teams are also not allowed to bid on more players than they have current 1st round picks for. *(Can only be "winning" as many auctions as you have a current 1st round pick for)* Any "illegal" bids will not be honored.
- A GM of a FT player can decline to match the current high bid ***during the franchise tag auction.*** *That team can then* enter the auction as a bidder (if they didn't have a draft pick) using the 1st round pick that they received from the FT player.

Once the Auction is Complete:

- If any bids take place, the owner of the franchised player must match the winning bid or decline to match the offer by the deadline.
- GMs declining to match the offer will accept compensation for the 1st round draft pick mentioned in the highest bid comment for the franchise tagged player.
- If a GM doesn't provide an answer to match/decline an offer by the deadline, the lack of response will be a "decline" and the player will go to the highest bidder.
- If no bids are received for the tagged player, the original team will keep the player at the opening bid amount *(The team may still determine the contract length, utilizing the 5%-10% discounts for long term deals).*

Contract Extension for Franchise Tagged Player

- The team receiving the franchised player can opt to extend the tentative 1-year agreement. The salary amount is determined by the winning bid.
- If the player receives a 2-year contract extension, the player's salary will be reduced by 5%.
- If a player receives a 3-4 year extension, the player's salary will be reduced by 10%.
- The first year of the contract is still 100% guaranteed and cut penalties apply to future years.

Section 4.3: TCL Transition Tag Auction

2026 TCL Transition Tag Auction key date(s):

- Noon on Second Saturday in April

Auction Details:

- Start date/time: **April TBD, 2026**
- End date/time: When activity stops
- Players will be placed up for auction via TCL MFL site
- Timer: 14-hour clock; clock restarts when high-bidder changes
- Bids: Actual bids (not using proxy bids)
- Increase amount: $100k
- Requirement to bid: In order to bid, the team **must own** a 2025 3rd round pick

Bid Process:

- When a team makes a bid on a tagged/tendered player... the team ***MUST*** include which pick is being used in the bid comment section (***FOR EVERY BID***). [Note - If a GM places a bid WITHOUT designating a draft pick, that bid is considered unofficial. The GM will be required to up the bid $100k & designate the draft pick in the comments for it to be official. If an auction ends on an unofficial bid, the previous official bid/pick will be the ending price/offer.]
- The designated pick is locked in and immovable (can't be traded or used to bid on another player) until the auction is complete or until another team takes over as high bidder. A team may not change the draft pick in their bid with a new bid of their own unless another team first becomes the high bidder.
- Teams are not allowed to bid on players if the franchised player will put the bidding team over the hard cap. Teams are also not allowed to bid on more players than they have current 3rd round picks for. *(Can only be "winning" as many auctions as you have a current 3rd round pick for)* Any "illegal" bids will not be honored.

- A GM of a TT player can decline to match the current high bid ***during the franchise tag auction.*** *That team can then* enter the auction as a bidder (if they didn't have a draft pick) using the 3rd round pick that they received from the FT player.

Once the Auction is Complete:

- If no bid is received, the owner of the transitioned player will retain the player on a 1 year deal.

- If any bids take place, the owner of the transitioned player must match the winning bid or decline to match the offer by the deadline.
- GMs declining to match the offer will accept compensation for the 3rd round draft pick mentioned in the highest bid comment for the franchise tagged player.
- If a GM doesn't provide an answer to match/decline an offer by the deadline, the lack of response will be a "decline" and the player will go to the highest bidder.
- If no bids are received for the tagged player, the original team will keep the player at the opening bid amount *(The team may still determine the contract length, utilizing the 5%-10% discounts for long term deals).*

Contract Extension for Franchise Tagged Player

- The team receiving the franchised player can opt to extend the tentative 1-year agreement. The salary amount is determined by the winning bid.
- If the player receives a 2-year contract extension, the player's salary will be reduced by 5%.
- If a player receives a 3-4 year extension, the player's salary will be reduced by 10%.
- The first year of the contract is still 100% guaranteed and cut penalties apply to future years.

Section 4.4: TCL Restricted Free Agency (RFA) Auction

2028-29 TCL RFA Auction key date(s):

- TBD 2029

Auction Details:

- Start date/time: **TBD 2029**
- End date/time: When activity stops
- Players will be placed up for auction via TCL MFL site
- Timer: 14-hour clock; clock restarts when high-bidder changes
- Bids: Actual bids (not using proxy bids)
- Increase amount: $100k
- Requirement to bid: In order to bid, the team **must own** a 2025 pick for compensation; based on the round of the tender.

Bid Process:

- When a team makes a bid on a tendered player... the team *__MUST__* include which pick is being used in the bid comment section (*__FOR EVERY BID__*). [Note - If a GM places a bid WITHOUT designating a draft pick, that bid is considered unofficial. The GM will be required to up the bid $100k & designate the draft pick in

the comments for it to be official. If an auction ends on an unofficial bid, the previous official bid/pick will be the ending price/offer.]

- The designated pick is locked in and immovable (can't be traded or used to bid on another player) until the auction is complete or until another team takes over as high bidder. A team may not change the draft pick in their bid with a new bid of their own unless another team first becomes the high bidder.
- Teams are not allowed to bid on players if the player will put the bidding team over the hard cap. Teams are also not allowed to bid on more players than they have draft picks for. Any "illegal" bids will not be honored.
- A GM of a RFA player can decline to match the current high bid during the RFA auction. That team can then choose to take the pick and/or re-enter the auction as a bidder (if they didn't have a draft pick previously). In order to do so, the GM must post their decision to decline the bid to the OFFICIAL: RFA Match / Decline / Extend message board on the MFL site**.**

Once the Auction is Complete:

- If any bids take place, the owner of the RFA tendered player must match the winning bid or decline to match the offer by the deadline.
- GMs declining to match the offer will accept compensation for the draft pick mentioned in the highest bid comment for the RFA tendered player.
- If a GM doesn't provide an answer to match/decline an offer by the deadline, the lack of response will be a "decline" and the player will go to the highest bidder.
- If no bids are received for the RFA player, the original team will keep the player at the opening bid amount *(The team may still determine the contract length, utilizing the 5%-10% discounts for long term deals).*

Contract Extension for RFA Tendered Player

- The team receiving the RFA player can opt to extend the tentative 1-year agreement. The salary amount is determined by the winning bid.
- If the player receives a 2-year contract extension, the player's salary will be reduced by 5%.
- If a player receives a 3-4 year extension, the player's salary will be reduced by 10%.

Section 4.5: TCL Free Agency

2025 TCL FA Startup Auction key date(s):

- July TBD, 2025 12 pm EDT

2026 TCL FA Auction key date(s):

- May TBD, 2026 12 pm EDT

<u>Veteran Free Agent Slow-Auction (First UFA auction of the off-season)</u>

- Bids will be made in increments of $100.
- Auction is open for approximately 3-weeks, depending on the rate of activity.
- Each conference conducts a separate auction since players cannot be traded between the two conferences.
- This is a slow-auction where a player will be on the bidding floor for 14-hours. If the high bidder changes, the timer starts over. [Depending on the speed of the auction, the timer may be reduced.]

- 100 players are able to be on the auction floor at one time. Each team can nominate 7 players onto the auction floor at any given time. [Depending on the speed of the auction, the number of players available on the auction floor could change.]
- Teams are ONLY able to acquire veteran players (no rookies).
- Players acquired through the auction cannot be cut and re-signed by the same team who cut them during the same auction. [For example, a team cannot win Matt Breida, cut him, then sign him again in the same auction that he was originally acquired for.]
- The amount of players you acquire is up to you. It is not required to meet 48-55 players from this auction.
- GMs will have to specify each acquired player's contract length (1-4 years) within 48-hours of the end of the auction by using the Official Contract thread on the message board.
- If players are acquired through this auction and are cut prior to September 5th (6pm EST), the player is cut at 60% of his salary and the team **must pay the next season cut fee** if he is signed to a multi-year contract. (see cut charts)

Section 4.6: TCL Rookie Draft

2025 TCL Rookie Draft key date(s): Format Slow - Clock TBD

- 1st - 7th Round - Mid July 2025

2026 TCL Rookie Draft key date(s): Format TBD.. Live or Slow

- 1st Round - Live June 2nd, TBD ET

- 2nd Round - Live June 3rd, TBD ET

- 3rd - 7th Round - Online Draft June 6th, 12:00 PM ET

1. The TCL holds an annual, seven-round rookie draft each season. The draft is split into the following:

    - A live, two-round rookie draft is conducted for rounds 1-2. Dates/times will be identified on the TCL Calendar.
    - The draft is continued as an online draft, via the MFL page, for rounds 3-7. The timer is set to 4 hours to allow GMs the opportunity to trade draft picks.

2. The draft order is determined by the following criteria:

    - **2025 Draft: Draft Pick Auction -** The 2025 Draft Order will be determined by an auction. Refer to the 2025 Draft Pick Auction post on MFL.

    - **2026 Draft and Beyond: Lowest potential points** for non-playoff teams will receive the earlier picks. A team's total PP is based on NFL weeks 1-13 (TCL regular season).

      1.1 = lowest PP
      1.2 = lowest PP
      1.3 = lowest PP
      1.4 = lowest PP
      …1.18 = highest PP

    - For playoff teams, it will be determined by finishing position. The teams that reach the Super Bowl will always receive the 15th and 16th picks in their conference.

- For the wildcard and divisional round elimination of the playoffs when two teams exit simultaneously, the lower seed gets the earlier pick. [Ex. If both the 3rd and 7th seed exit the wildcard at the same time, the 7th seed would pick 10th and the 3rd seed would pick 11th.]

3. "Draft eligible players" are defined as any player that is considered draft eligible by NFL guidelines. This excludes players who did not declare in a timely manner or meet NFL qualifications for that year's draft. All "draft eligible" players, whether drafted by an NFL team or not, shall be eligible for the league's rookie draft.

Section 4.7: Rookie Draft Pay Scale

1. The rookie pay scale will be as close to 100% of the current year's NFL rookie draft class' pay scale as possible. *[Please note, the rookie pay scale will have minor changes each season as it is based off of the NFL's salaries, but customized for the TCL.]*
2. Rookie salaries will be located on the **Rookie Draft Board Tracker**, which can be found on the MFL league page.

Section 4.8: Compensatory Picks

1. Each season, 18 compensatory draft picks are awarded to the 18 teams who failed to make the playoffs (9 teams per conference). All compensatory picks are awarded at the end of rounds 2, 3, and 4. The picks are awarded per conference as follows, with the worst ranked team receiving the first compensatory pick based on: worst record, followed by lowest points.

   - **2nd round compensatory picks** - The teams who finished as the 14th, 15th, and 16th of their conference receive an additional 2nd round pick. The picks start as the 17th pick of the round. *For example, the 16th ranked team would receive the 1st compensatory pick, the 15th ranked team would receive the 2nd compensatory pick, and the 14th team would receive the 3rd compensatory pick.*
   - **3rd round compensatory picks** – The teams who finished ranked 11th, 12th, and 13th in their conference receive an additional 3rd round pick. The picks start as the 17th pick of the round.
   - **4th round compensatory picks** – The teams who finished as 8th, 9th and 10th in their conference receive an additional 4th round pick. The picks start as the 17th pick of the round.

2. Compensatory picks are tradable.
3. Compensatory pick salaries are the same as the 16th pick of that round.

Section 4.9: UDFA Auction

2025 TCL UDFA Auction key date(s):

- Noon on last Saturday in June

- 2025: July TBD at noon EDT

Purpose: This auction will allow teams to expand their rosters for the off-season program. It will include ONLY rookies who were not drafted during the TCL Rookie Draft.

- Initial auction salary will be set to $795k (rookie minimum).
- Bids will be made in increments of $1k.
- A 14-hour timer will be used. If the high bidder changes, the timer will reset.
- An unlimited number of players can be nominated at any given time.
- Auction will be open for approximately two weeks; depending on the rate of activity.

- All players signed from the UDFA auction will be given 3-year contracts.
- These contracts are not considered “Rookie Contracts” as the player may hold out if he meets the holdout criteria.

- GMs can have as many or as few players as they would like. It is not required to meet 48-55 players from this auction.

Section 4.10: NFL Camp/Preseason FA Auction

2025 TCL 2nd Veteran FA Auction key date(s):

- 1st day of August every year

- 2025: Open - August 1st at noon ET/Close - August 31st at 4 pm ET

Purpose: This auction will allow teams to expand their rosters for the off-season program. It will include any free agent (rookie or veteran).

- Initial auction salary will be set to $1.125m (veteran minimum).
- Bids will be made in increments of $1k.
- An 8-hour timer will be used. If the high bidder changes, the timer will reset.
- Players acquired through the auction cannot be cut and re-signed by the same team who cut them during the same auction. [For example, a team cannot win Tom Brady, cut him, then sign him again in the same auction that he was originally acquired for.]
- An unlimited number of players can be nominated at any given time.
- Auction will be open until the end of August every year
- GMs will have to specify each acquired player’s contract length (1-4 years) within 48-hours of the end of the auction by using the Official Contract thread on the message board.
- These contracts are not considered “Rookie Contracts” as the player may hold out if he meets the holdout criteria.

- Retired players whose rights are not owned by a TCL team may be bid on in FA if their name is still in the MFL database.

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ARTICLE 5 - REGULAR SEASON & PLAYOFF SCHEDULE

Section 5.1: Regular Season in 2025

1. The TCL regular season consists of 17 games during weeks 1-13 of the NFL’s season..
2. Achieving 17-games during 13-weeks requires doubleheaders, where each franchise plays two head-to-head matchups instead of the standard one head-to-head match for that designated week. Doubleheader weeks could change season to season as the NFL’s schedule will be reviewed to minimize the impact of the NFL bye weeks.

3. The TCL doubleheader weeks are determined with a few minor steps. Eligible weeks will be determined as weeks with 0-2 teams on bye and not the first week of the season. Once the eligible weeks are determined they will be randomly drawn by a randomizer. For example, in 2022 there are seven qualifying weeks: 2, 3, 4,

5, 8, 11 and 12. The commissioners will drop them into a randomizer and determine the assigned weeks for the current season's schedule.

a. The 2025 eligible weeks are: TBD

b. The 2025 doubleheader weeks drawn by randomizer are: TBD

Section 5.2: Playoffs

1. The league's playoffs occur during weeks 14-17 of the NFL's schedule.
2. The playoff bracket consists of 14 franchises (7 from each conference).
3. The playoffs are determined and seeded using the following criteria at the end of the regular season:

- Each division champion automatically qualifies for the playoffs (4 franchises from each conference).
- The top franchise in each conference with the highest highest winning percentage (head to head then total points as tiebreaker) is awarded the #1 seed and earns a first-round bye week.
- Wild Card spots are awarded to the 6 franchises (3 from each conference) with the highest winning percentage regardless of division. The Wild Card teams earn the #5, #6 & #7 playoff seeds. The three Wild Card teams will face off against the three division winners. The division champions are always seeded higher than a Wild Card team.
- During the first round of the playoffs, the #2 seed plays the #7 seed, the #3 seed plays the #6 seed, and the #4 seed plays the #5 seed.

- **Tiebreakers [Section 5.3]**

  - Divisional standings/winning club is determined by head to head (best won-lost percentage in games between the clubs) and then total points.

  - Conference/wildcard standings and seeding are determined by first applying the divisional tiebreakers to eliminate all but the highest-ranked club remaining in each division and then a 'head to head sweep' (if all tied teams were defeated by one club). If no matchup was played or no sweep determined then the tiebreaker moves to total point totals.

  - Once a Wild-Card club has been identified, the procedure is repeated to identify the next Wild-Card club.

4. **Playoff Reseeding** – If applicable, the second round will reseed, or adjust the matchups to ensure the highest seeded team plays the lowest seeded team. Playoff reseeding occurs when there is an upset in the first round of the playoffs.
5. **Playoff Waivers** – In the event a playoff match between two teams ends within a 15 point margin, both teams will be allowed to participate in the following week's waiver period to allow for stat corrections to run their course. Should the eventual losing team win any players; those players will be awarded to the next highest bidding team that is still in the playoffs via the reports on MFL (REPORTS>FRANCHISE>PREVIOUSLY PROCESSED WAIVERS) or returned to the waiver pool if no one else bids on them.

6. The Playoff schedule is listed below:

- WEEK 14: Wild Card (6 teams per conference)

- WEEK 15: Divisional Round (4 teams per conference)
- WEEK 16: Conference Round (2 teams per conference)
- WEEK 17: TCL Super Bowl - Championship Game

Section 5.3: Tiebreakers

1. **Regular Season Tiebreakers** -The following, based on best-to-worst per category.

#1: Overall Winning Percentage
#2: Head-To-Head Record *(**For Wildcard**: only splits up a tie between teams if all teams involved in the tie have played each other)*
#3: Total Points Scored
#4: Divisional Winning Percentage
#5: Conference Winning Percentage
#6: Power Rank

2. **Playoff Game Tie Breakers** - If a Playoff game ends in a tie, the following tie breaker criteria is used to declare the winner (best-to-worst)(based on that week/game only):

#1: Most Total Yards (Rushing + Passing + Receiving)
#2: Most Total Touchdowns (Rushing + Passing + Receiving + IDPs TD's)
#3: Longest Touchdown
#4: Most Field Goals
#5: Longest Field Goal
#6: Most Safeties
#7: Highest Seeded Team

3. **Super Bowl Tie Breakers** - Tie games will be decided by the same criteria used for Playoff Games. If the game is still tied, the game will be awarded to the highest seeded team.

Section 5.4: Toilet Bowl

1. The league's Toilet Bowls occur during weeks 14-17 of the NFL's schedule.
2. Each conference has their own TB bracket, one for the AFC and one for the NFC.
3. The TB bracket consists of 18 franchises (9 from each conference).
4. The TB brackets are determined and seeded using the following criteria at the end of the regular season:

    - Each team missing the TCL Playoffs automatically qualifies for the TB.
    - The seeds are determined based on the final Standings from the regular season. Seed #9 has the best winning percentage in the conference, up to the #1 seed having the worst winning percentage in the conference.
    - The league standard tiebreaker rules are used to break tied teams (head to head then total points).
    - **Tiebreakers [Section 5.3]**

        - Divisional standings/winning club is determined by head to head (best won-lost percentage in games between the clubs) and then total points.

        - Conference/wildcard standings and seeding are determined by first applying the divisional tiebreakers to eliminate all but the highest-ranked club remaining in each division and then a

'head to head sweep' (if all tied teams were defeated by one club). If no matchup was played or no sweep determined then the tiebreaker moves to total point totals.

- Once a Wild-Card club has been identified, the procedure is repeated to identify the next Wild-Card club.

5. **Toilet Bowl Waivers** – As of the 2025 TCL season teams competing in the TB are ineligible for waiver wire and FCFS players. Rosters are set once the regular season is completed.
6. **Toilet Bowl Winners** - As of the 2025 TCL season the AFC and NFC Toilet Bowl winning franchises will be rewarded with the 2.20 picks in the upcoming TCL Draft.

ARTICLE 6 – MEDIA RELATIONS & PARTICIPATION

Section 6.1: Participation

1. The league has been developed to foster a fun, entertaining environment that hinges on each GM participating in the league.
2. We expect you to **be active on chat** and to respond to inquiries from the media team personalities. Inquiries can include your thoughts on matchups, season outlooks, recent trades, draft selections, free agency, or any other league related topics. **Bottom line, HAVE FUN!**
3. If you're interested in hosting your own show or writing articles, please contact the TCL Media Team.
4. **Life happens:** People's lives change and with it, their priorities. Other life priorities may occur that forces a GM to not have the time required for the league. Teams should make the Commissioner aware of life changes that can have an effect on their overall participation with the media. Notifying the Commissioner gives situational awareness to the event and allows the Commissioner to workout alternatives until life is returned back to normal.

ARTICLE 7 – VIOLATIONS AND PENALTIES

Section 7.1: Roster Violations and Penalties

<u>Formation Violations</u>

1. Each team must start one of the permitted formations on both offense and defense. [Please see Article 2, Section 4: Starting Lineup for information on valid formations.] In the event that MFL's rosters or starting lineup capabilities are limited, the Commissioner may extend the limits to incorporate an TCL rule (e.g. permitted formations, roster position limits, etc.). It is the GM's responsibility to ensure that their roster and starting lineup is in accordance with the league's bylaws. Failure to do so will result in a salary cap penalty.
2. In the event that an illegal lineup slips through the cracks; the commissioner of the opposing conference will substitute out the highest scoring player at the position that broke the lineup/formation, and sub-in the lowest scoring player on the bench that will make the lineup legal.
   (ex. If a team starts 4 RBs: commish will sub out the top scoring RB for the lowest available WR/TE)

Tanking Violations

1. If a team is found to be tanking on purpose - that team will receive a $25m cap fine the upcoming season and loss of a future 1st Round Selection.
2. The Commissioner of the conference involved will use discretion to single out any obvious tanking situations, and will put the violation to a league vote. 75% of the league must be in agreement that the team in question indeed did tank.

Insufficient Starting Lineup Violations

1. GMs have ample time to make moves to acquire team depth as well as to plan around their players' **bye** week schedule. Teams that place a player in their starting lineup who is on a **bye** week shall be reported to the Commissioner and are subject to a penalty below. [Note - Players on BYE must be in the starting lineup at the close of that week to be considered an illegal lineup.]
2. If a team's lineup violates the rules due to a NFL game delay or cancellation, **no penalty** will be handed down.

Active Roster Violations

1. GMs are required to meet the roster minimum and maximum by the designated date post NFL Cutdown Day. The commissioners will provide the date with ample time and league activities for the GMs to acquire their required players.
    a. 2025 Active Roster - 48-55 players
    b. 2025 TCL Cutdown date - September 1st

Penalty for Roster Violation or Insufficient Starting Lineup Violation

1. The following outlines punishment for a team who violates the roster/starting lineup rules in a given year:

2. **Infraction penalties** - 1st infraction is a **warning**, 2nd infraction is a **1%** cap hit, 3rd violation is a **3%** cap hit, 4th violation is a **6%** cap hit and the 5th and final violation is a **removal** from the league.

    a. All cap hits are added up and charged against the following year's cap amount.

3. **A penalty will be incurred for the following lineup infractions:**

    - Starting a player on BYE (FAs, aka players not on an NFL team are considered to always be on BYE)
    - Starting a player on IR
    - Tanking
    - Illegal roster (3 cornerbacks, no QB, aka illegal formation)
    - Starting Suspended players
    - Starting players who are OUT before Sunday (some common sense/leniency will be applied here.

4. If any of the above basic guidelines are broken, the team will incur a cap hit for the FOLLOWING year. Each infraction will be treated as a separate occurrence.

Example: If a team starts two players on BYE, it will receive 2 separate penalties.

5. Additionally, starting players who are deemed to be Out (O) for the week BEFORE game day Sunday will also be eligible for a fine. This one will be left to commissioner discretion because there are unique cases.

6. Typically, teams know who is out based on lack of practice all week long and will announce inactives by Saturday. Should a player be deemed out on Sunday morning (game time decision), the team would be clear of league punishment. We will rely on credible news outlets to determine when a player was deemed OUT. It is your job to monitor your player's statuses. A player will also generally be marked (D) for Doubtful well in advance of them being ruled Out.

7. This is a rule that will be enforced by the league. It is not the commissioner's job to check lineups each week, so if we miss one; it is not due to selective application of the rule. It's because YOU missed it or didn't report it.

    a. *If a GM that has incurred fines quits the league - the fines would be waived for the replacement GM.

    b. In the event that action is required from the front office to rectify a roster error or **Active Roster Violation**, the commissioners will use the following 'order of operations' to resolve any roster related issue:

        i. Release player(s) who is currently an NFL free agent (players not on an NFL team) at current cap hit.

        ii. Make Taxi Squad moves on the team's behalf (most expensive/related position first).

        iii. Release the most recently acquired players at current cap hit.

ARTICLE 8 – MISC INFORMATION

Section 8.1: Bylaw Changes - League Voting

1. The NFL is constantly adapting and evolving with the times to remain the most thriving sports league in the world. Therefore, our league will also evolve and adapt to remain the most dynamic dynasty fantasy football league possible. For this reason, the league Commissioners will constantly research the best possible methods in running our dynasty league. Often, the Commissioners will conduct opinion polls, seek feedback, and search the Internet for the best trends in fantasy football.
2. Each season, the Commissioners will use this research as well as league input to decide on possible rule changes that might improve the league. Rule changes will be voted upon by the league. Especially if the rule change will go into effect mid-season. Minor rule changes, such as event dates or time changes, may be made at the Commissioner's discretion.
3. Teams are encouraged to suggest possible rule changes to the league using the **League Improvement Ideas** message board thread or the **Owners Meeting Slack chat room.**
4. The Commissioners will use discretion to determine which rule suggestions go to a league vote.
5. For a rule change to take effect, the vote must receive a 66% vote(22 of 32) in favor of the change, unless otherwise specified.
6. The Commissioners reserve the right to close loopholes and fix broken rules that are detrimental to the overall league without a league vote.

Section 8.2: Annual Owners Meeting

1. We will hold an 'Owners Meeting' vote each January which will allow all 32 GMs the chance to vote on approved topics.
2. It is recommended that all rule suggestions be hashed out in the Improvement Ideas Slack room, so that we can get differing perspectives on the proposed changes and can work to improve on an idea before it goes to vote.
3. The commissioners will put together the final ballot with all proposed rule changes. Each proposal will have a description which highlights the pros and cons of the change as well as any other considerations that must be taken into account.
4. For a rule change to take effect, the vote must receive 75% vote in favor of the change, unless otherwise specified.

Section 8.3: Accidental Drops, Trades, or Other Errors

1. Mistakes happen. We will do our best to correct those mistakes using common sense and a very simple process to demonstrate a mistake has indeed been made. However, not all mistakes/errors can be corrected. Please read this section carefully to increase the likelihood that honest errors may be corrected.

Trading Mistakes

1. **All trades are final!** Please ensure you read and agree to all the terms of the trade offer before approving the trade. In the event a questionable trade is made (e.g. potential collusion or blatant mistake), the Commissioner will use his best judgment to determine if the trade should be challenged. [Please see Section 3.13: Challenging Trades.]

Other Errors (such as dropping a player by mistake, drafting errors, etc.)

1. The first and **most important step after making a mistake is to immediately post a message board topic giving a detailed explanation of the error that occurred**. In addition to this you should also email the Commissioner the same explanation. It is important to have a public record of the mistake for all league members to see. Transparency is very important! Mistakes will not be corrected until the error is posted publicly.
2. Just because a mistake/error was posted does not mean it will be reversed. Each issue is unique and some may not be easily corrected. For instance if a team drafts the wrong player by mistake and 5 other teams make their selection before the error can be fixed, the Commissioner may choose not to correct the error as the next 5 teams already showed everyone their selections.

An immediate response to errors will be the main determining factor that a mistake has been made.
The Commissioner will use his best judgment in determining the validity of a mistake claim.
The Commissioner's decision is final.

Section 8.4: Procedure for Owner Removal

1. In the event that a GM completely checks out (stops setting lineups, logging in, etc), the Commissioners will reach out to the GM in question in order to evaluate the situation.

a. If the GM does not respond or decides to move on, the Commissioners will seek a replacement in order to keep the league full and competitive. The commissioners will also step in to ensure the team has a full lineup set each week to protect the integrity of the playoff race.

2. **Owner Removal Process (Voting)**
   a. At Least eight (8) (25%) TCL members must file a motion to remove an TCL Owner. Each of the eight (8) members will convene and create a single message board post. Each will post their reasoning as to why he/she should be removed. This will be posted to the MFL league board as OWNER REMOVAL MOTION {GM name}. Owner removal motions will be blacked out during the Regular season weeks 12 through the entirety of playoffs.

3. **The motion will be in one post and pre-formatted as follows:**
   a. OWNER REMOVAL MOTION
   b. OWNER NAME:
   c. STATEMENT ON WHY:
   d. Signed by:
   e. Signed by statements:
   f. Co-signed by #s (2-8):
   g. Co-signed by #s (2-8) statements:

4. **Motion Vote:**
   a. The motion will then be voted on by the TCL members. The voting window will be open for 24 hours. Sixteen (16) (50%) **yes votes** will approve the motion to continue to a formal Owner Removal Proceeding.
5. **Formal Owner Removal Proceedings:**
   a. A 48-hour window of discussion and defense begins. During this time, the potential GM who will be removed and other members can plead their cases to the league. Commissioners will not be required to reply to owners or motion co-signers via DM and will be able to cast a vote and voice independent of their duties to govern.
   b. At the end of the 48-hour discussion and defense window; the Formal Owner Removal vote will begin. All 31 members are required to vote within 12 hours. 23.25 rounded down (75%) Yes votes will trigger the removal and refund (if applicable) of the owner and the TCL will begin a new member search.
   c. An owner in bad standing may not trade, drop players, vote, or make other roster moves until the completion of the voting process.
6. **Cooldown Period:**
   a. In the event the vote resulted in not removing the GM, there will be a minimum of 6 months before the same owner can be put up for vote again by another group. The commissioners reserve the right to remove an owner if it is in the best interest of the league (ex. Owner cuts the entire team or becomes a total shitbird to the community, etc).

Section 8.5: Replacement Owner: Contract Amnesty & Trades

1. When a replacement owner takes over a vacant team, they will have the option of applying a contract amnesty. **Within 5 days of joining the league**, new owners will have to decide between two options (if no selection is made, option A is chosen by default):

   - **Option A –** Retain roster and team entirely as is.
   - **Option B –** Retain roster, change contract lengths up to 5 players for any non-rookie contracts and void up to 5-contracts. All changes in contract lengths or voiding contracts can only be applied to players currently on the roster. You cannot trade for a player and apply any changes to that player. **The new GM has 7-days to submit their new contract lengths & 5 player cuts.** The player(s) are dropped and become a free agent

without a salary cap penalty. All transactions (e.g. player cut penalties, trades, etc.) from the previous owner remain with the team and the new owner. However, the new owner can apply any of their available 5-cuts to remove a previous salary cap penalty. Salary cap penalties from the previous GM for poor management (e.g. roster violations/penalties) **will no**t be transferred to the replacement GM.

2. Teams under new ownership are not allowed to trade for their first 7-days in the league. This is to give the new GM time to become accustomed to the league rules, scoring system, and team needs.
3. In the event of a mid-season change at GM, the new GM will still have the ability to make trades after the 7-day no-trading period has finished. The amendments to player's contracts and the option to cut 5-players will occur in the off-season. However, those adjustments/cuts are only available for players who were on the roster when the new GM took over.
4. New GMs will be given a 1-year probationary period, where they are eligible to be voted out without receiving 5 negative complaints. *(Reserved for GMs who don't fit the TCL culture.)*

Section 8.6: Dispersal Draft (Multiple Vacancies in Same Offseason)

1. When there are two or more vacancies in a given off-season, the league will host a dispersal draft.
2. All team assets will be combined in a draft pool, including draft picks.
3. All salaries and contracts will be retained (including contract statuses: RC, FT, RC1).
4. Any pending holdouts will be ignored.
5. All team cap penalties will be removed.
6. Any players on 0 year deals (expired) will head to free agency barring the use of a FT, Tender, or 5th Year Option.
   Each team may use…

   - As many 5th year options as there are expired RC1s.
   - 1 franchise tag to pull an expired contract player away from the impending free agency and into the conference franchise tag auction.
   - Two tenders (1st/2nd/3rd rounds) which must comply with the standard tender rules.

These tags may be used on any player whose contract is set to expire on any of the open teams. To use these options, the team must simply draft a 0 year contract player at any point during the draft and notify the commissioner of intent to use one of the options (and which).

7. Only the dispersal teams may participate in this auction.
8. Teams are not required to have a complete team by the end of this auction.
9. Teams will take turns selecting from any existing contracts and draft picks until they decide to stop.
10. Teams may bow out at any point if they lose interest in the remaining assets.
11. The Dispersal Draft will be a 3rd round reversal snake draft. Draft order will be determined randomly (dice roll app within slack or lotto). To roll the dice in slack "/roll 1d10000"

Section 8.7: Force Majeure

These rules are inactive by default and must be called upon by a league vote if/when they are needed during a world event that affects the NFL season in a major way. This section of the bylaws is open to additional change via league votes as we see how things play out.

1. **Activating Force Majeure Rules (Voting)**
   At Least eight (8) (25%) TCL members must file a motion to enact the Force Majeure Clause for the current

season. Each of the eight (8) members will convene and create a single message board post. Each will post their reasoning.

The motion will then be voted on by the TCL members. The voting window will be open for 24 hours. Twenty Four (24) (75%) yes votes will approve the motion to enact the Force Majeure Clause for a given season/offseason.

The term of the force majeure can be no longer than 1 regular season (and the following offseason) without the league re-convening for a second vote to extend for an additional season (25% in favor to enact a vote followed by a 75% yes vote – same as above).

Example: If the league votes to enact the FM clause in October during the 2045 season, the clause would remain in effect for the remainder of the season through the completion of the next offseason and would expire at the start (August) of the 2046 regular season.

2. **If Season is Played During Force Majeure...**

1. Players that opt out at any point before or during the season are eligible for IR. Standard IR rules apply *(can leave them on IR all year, but can not demote them after they have recovered/returned).*
2. Players that are quarantined/sidelined due to exposure to COVID-19 *(COVID-20, COVID-21, Whatever the purpose of our force majeure is)* are eligible for IR. Standard IR rules apply *(can leave them on IR all year, but can not demote them after they have recovered/returned)*
3. Cap penalties and roster violations still apply.
4. Players that opt out **before** the season starts are eligible for an optional contract freeze. To freeze the contract, the GM must post to the correct message board thread with their intent to freeze the contract by the deadline (August 31st) with a news article mentioning that the player opted out.

3. **If Season is Cancelled or Cut Short During Force Majeure (16 weeks are not played)**

1. The TCL will freeze contracts and restart the next year with the same rosters.
2. There will be no coach, FT, TT, RFA, WT auctions.
3. We will still host a rookie draft, UDFA auction, and free agency.
4. Entry fees will roll over. (We may be required to collect for MFL, & TCLsite fees)
5. No Winner.
6. No payouts.
7. Each team will be afforded two contract cuts for free in the offseason.
8. The Rookie Draft Order will be determined by weighted lottery. Non-playoff teams (from the previous season) get 2 balls, playoff teams (from the previous season) get 1 ball.

ARTICLE 9 – ADDITIONAL LEAGUE EVENTS

We plan on hosting a few mini-games each season to keep GMs engaged and to allow for a few side opportunities to win some money. The following side games are not mandatory, however all 32 GMs are encouraged to participate. Buy-in can be altered, depending on league desire.

Section 9.1: TCL Pick'em Pool

Buy-in: $25 **Payout**: Winner take all

The object of the Pick em' Pool is to pick the most winning NFL teams each week for the duration of the NFL season. We do not use point spreads, you simply must pick who will win each NFL game each week. This challenge runs from weeks 1-17.

Section 9.2: TCL Survivor Pool

Buy-in: $25 **Payout**: Winner take all
Each week you pick one NFL team that you think will win their match for that week. You may only use each team once, so there is a lot of strategy here in terms of which team to go with each week. GMs that pick incorrectly are eliminated from the pool. The winner is the last man standing. We may start this one up multiple times a year.

Section 9.3: TCL Playoff League(TBD)

Buy-in: $25, $50 **Payout**: Winner take all
This is an all-play, ladder league which takes place for the NFL playoffs. The league is limited to 14 participants, but we may run a second league if demand for it exists. Teams are selected via a third round reversal draft. Draft order is automated and randomized via MFL. Scoring system is based on the TCL scoring system. Teams consist of: 1QB, 2RB, 3WR, 1TE, 1PK, 2DL, 2LB, 2DB. No bench, no trades, no waivers, no setting lineups. Each week, as NFL teams are eliminated from the playoffs, your playoff team will lose starters. The winner will be decided by most total points at the end of the super bowl.

Section 9.4: Super Bowl Squares

Buy-in: $10 each **Payout**: Q1: $200 Q2: $200 Q3: $200 FINAL: $400
Both teams and numbers (0-9) will be drawn from a hat/wig/helmet *(dependent on mood)* via live Google Hangout. At the end of each of the first 3 quarters & the end of the game, the last digits of each team's score will be used to determine the winner. Payments will be made via PayPal

ARTICLE 10 – FUTURE RULE CHANGES/IDEAS

Please visit Discord - Improvement Ideas to express your ideas for league changes.